

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: 2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey (survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work)

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global employment status (share of respondents)

Full-time



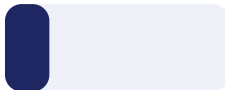
69%

Freelance / contracting



16.4%

Full-time student



13.2%



United States: full-time employment

69% (2023) →

64.8% (2024)

-4.2 percentage points YoY

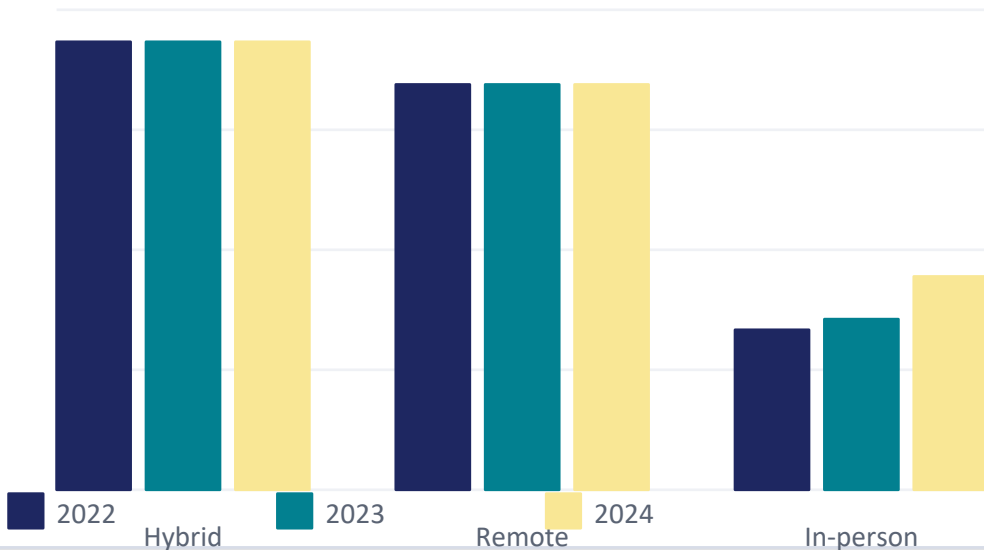


What this suggests

- Full-time is still the default globally (69%)
- Contracting remains material (16.4%)
- Student share is meaningful (13.2%)

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Work arrangement (share of respondents)



Key read

- Hybrid is most common (42%)
- Remote remains substantial (38%)
- In-person keeps climbing (15%→20%)

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median annual compensation (USD) — top 10 developer roles

Senior Executive		\$127,388
Dev Advocate		\$124,203
Manager		\$115,999
Dev Experience		\$109,483
SRE		\$99,099
Cloud Infra. Engineer		\$96,666
Blockchain		\$85,925
Product Manager		\$80,000



Context

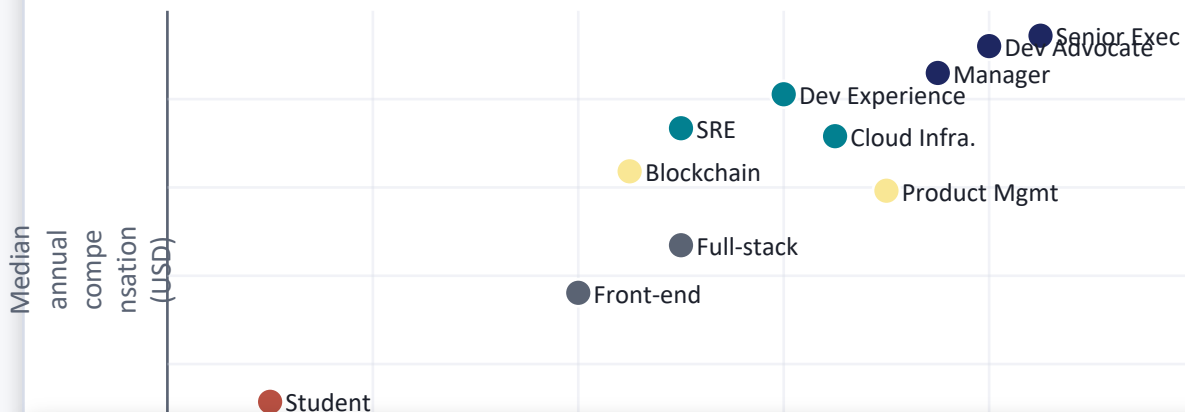
- 22,677 salary responses
- 34.7% response rate
- Highest-paid technical roles: SRE + Cloud infra.

Figure reference: Salary by developer type (from source)



Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary vs. average years of experience (developer type)



Upper-right cluster
= senior leadership +
DevRel roles

Student outlier:
~2 years, \$15,466

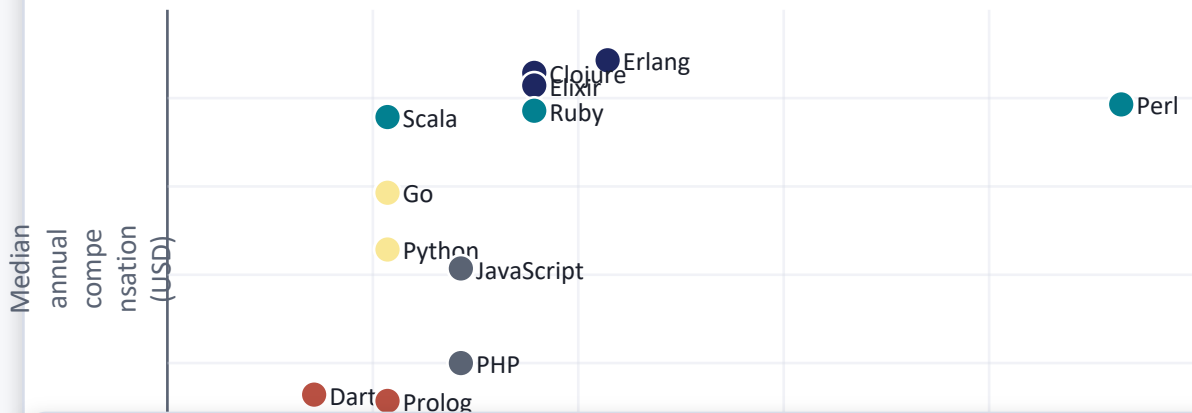
Figure reference: Salary vs. experience by developer type (from source)



seniority

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. average experience (programming language)



Average salary range
dropped ~\$10K vs 2023:
\$60–75K now
vs \$70–85K



Interpretation

- Niche function

Figure reference: Salary vs. experience by language (from source)



47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company size distribution (42,827 respondents)



Influence over tech purchases

62% of respondents



Preferred approach

60% prefer build-and-buy



Top evaluation methods

- Start a free trial (75%)
- Ask other developers (73%)

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention



Plan for a more mixed workforce

- U.S. full-time share fell (69%→64.8%).
- Contracting remains 16.4% globally.



Design hybrid-first policies

- Hybrid leads (42%), remote is 38%.
- In-person is rising (15%→20%).



Benchmark scarce roles competitively

- Premium pay for leadership + DevRel.
- SRE and Cloud Infra lead technical roles.



Use language signals thoughtfully

- Functional languages correlate with higher pay.
- Mainstream stacks cluster below ~\$65K median.

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